

At first glance, there appears to be no gender gap in AI use...

Share of employed adults who have used AI for a work task

Women



Men



Bars show 90% confidence intervals. The two overlap: the difference is within the survey's margin of error.

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Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Household Trends and Outlook Pulse Survey, March 2026.

Weighted; n = 6,573 employed adults.

The Census Bureau is revising the March 2026 weights. Weighted and unweighted analyses give the same pattern throughout.

The gender gap opens when you ask how often AI is used

The same workers, counted three ways

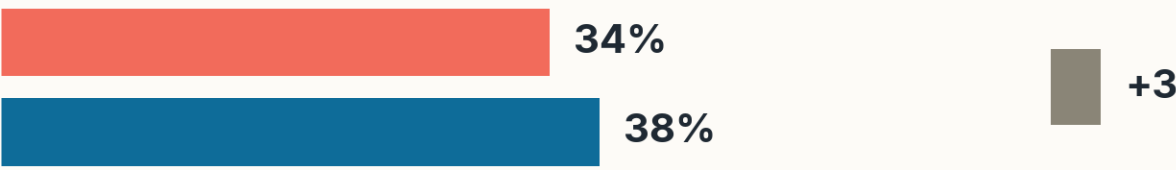
Women Men

Have used AI for a work task

gap, in points



Used AI at work last week



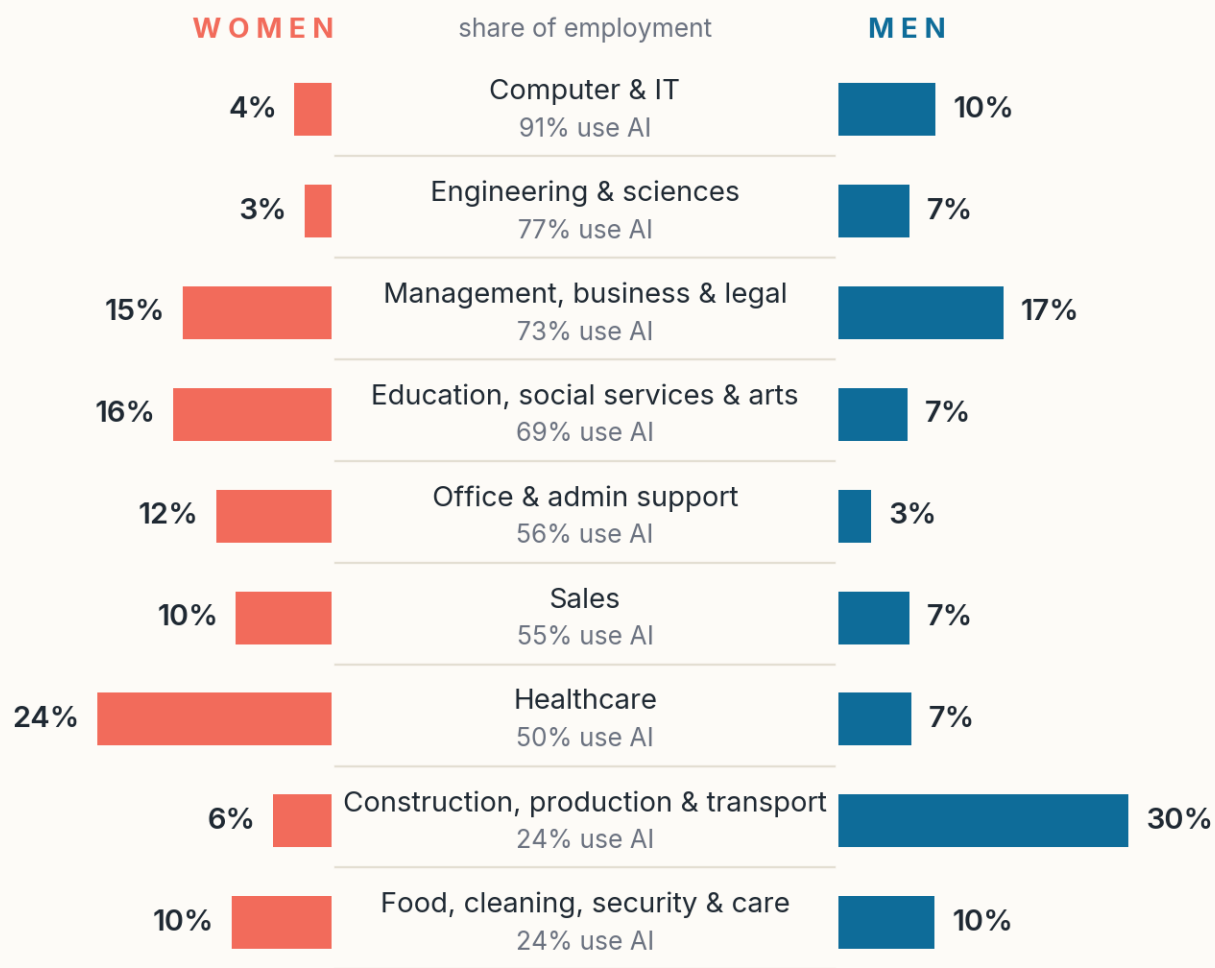
Used AI at work every day last week



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Household Trends and Outlook Pulse Survey, March 2026.
Weighted; n = 6,573 employed adults (6,550 for the frequency measures).
The Census Bureau is revising the March 2026 weights. Weighted and unweighted analyses give the same pattern throughout.

Women hold more jobs in 'High AI' occupations

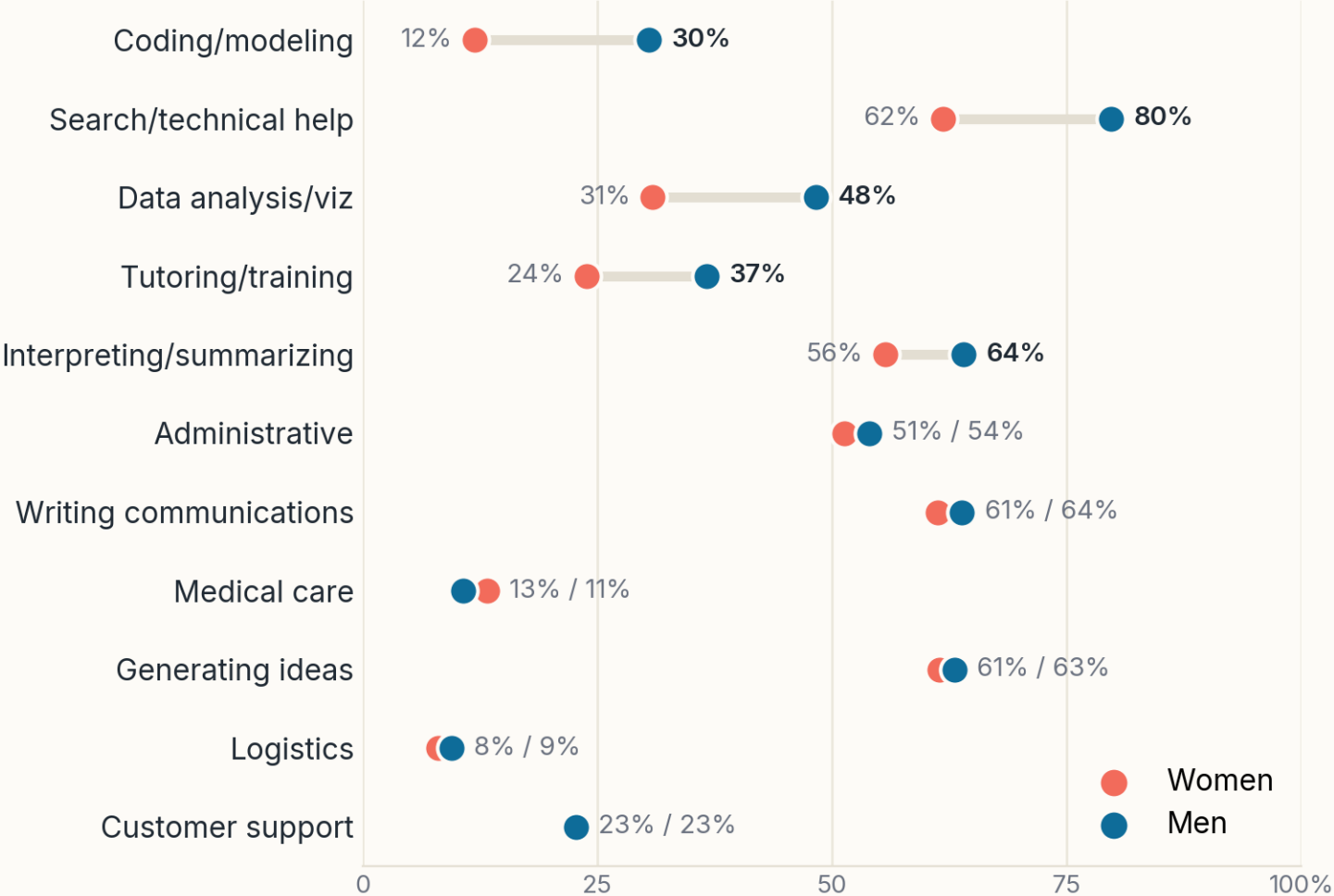
Women hold more jobs in occupations where most workers use AI — education, admin, and (at almost exactly half) healthcare. Men hold more of the construction, production and transport jobs, where AI use is very low. That alone should mean women use AI about 5 points more often than men. Something is going on inside the jobs.



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Household Trends and Outlook Pulse Survey, March 2026.
Weighted. Occupations ordered by the share of workers who have used AI. Farming, fishing and forestry omitted (1% of workers).
The Census Bureau is revising the March 2026 weights. Weighted and unweighted analyses give the same pattern throughout.

The gender gap is based on four technical tasks

Share of workers who use AI at work and report using it for this task



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Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Household Trends and Outlook Pulse Survey, March 2026.

Weighted; n = 4,091 workers who have used AI for at least one work task.

Data, code and the full write-up: github.com/marykatestimmler-dev/ai-at-work-gender-gap

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